SIDDHARTH RAO

Senior Data Scientist

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ABOUT

I have spent the last six years on machine learning problems, mostly NLP and recommendation systems. I like taking a fuzzy business question, turning it into something measurable, and shipping a model that people actually use. Currently leading a team of four data scientists.

EXPERIENCE

Senior Data Scientist , Lumen Health Analytics, Hyderabad Jan 2022 - Present

- Lead a team of 4 working on clinical text. We built an NLP pipeline that extracts diagnoses and medications from discharge summaries using spaCy and a fine-tuned BERT model (Hugging Face Transformers on TensorFlow).
- Set up the evaluation process for the team: labelled test sets, per-entity precision and recall, and an error review with the clinical team every sprint.
- Built a readmission risk model (XGBoost) with about 120 engineered features from claims and visit data. Two hospital partners use it to prioritise follow-up calls.
- Worked with data engineering to move training data from ad-hoc SQL extracts to versioned tables in Snowflake.
- Interview candidates and run an internal reading group on ML papers.

Data Scientist , Quickcart Commerce, Bengaluru Jun 2019 - Dec 2021

- Built product recommendation models for the home page, first matrix factorisation and later a two-tower model in Keras. Ran the A/B tests with the product team.
- Created a demand forecasting model for 2,000+ SKUs using LightGBM with holiday and promotion features.
- Clustered customers by purchase behaviour (K-Means, DBSCAN) to support pricing experiments.
- Wrote shared feature engineering code in pandas and NumPy that other analysts started reusing.

Analyst - Data Science , Infotrail Consulting, Hyderabad Jul 2017 - May 2019

- Built regression and classification models for marketing clients (response models, customer lifetime value).
- Cleaned and joined large survey and CRM datasets using SQL and Python.

SKILLS

Python, SQL, pandas, NumPy, scikit-learn, XGBoost, LightGBM, TensorFlow, Keras, PyTorch (basic), Hugging Face Transformers, spaCy, NLTK, MLflow, Docker, Git, Snowflake, AWS (SageMaker, S3, Lambda)

Techniques: supervised learning, clustering, NLP (NER, text classification, embeddings), recommender systems, time series forecasting, feature engineering, experiment design, model evaluation

EDUCATION

M.Tech, Computer Science , IIIT Hyderabad 2015 - 2017

Thesis: Topic modelling of Telugu news articles using LDA.

B.E., Computer Science , Osmania University, Hyderabad 2011 - 2015

TALKS AND WRITING

- Talk on lessons from deploying clinical NER at a local Python meetup, 2023.
- Co-author of a short workshop paper on Telugu topic modelling, 2017.

INTERESTS

Long-distance running (two half marathons so far), Carnatic music, teaching my nephew Python.